

Digital Literacy

Project Report

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Year	1 st year
Course Code	CSE0001
Date	27/03/2026

Introduction

This is a Digital Literacy project where I'm a Student Digital Ambassador. My experiences highlight a critical gap that exists among students today, i.e., the difference between being digitally active and being digitally aware.

This project explores key areas of digital literacy through five tasks : creating awareness, building responsible online presence , practising safe and effective collaboration, communicating professionally in digital spaces, and studying a case and its prevention guide. Each task required genuine reflection on how digital tools affect identity, learning, communication, and security along with technical participation.

The goal of this project is to move beyond tool usage and develop the awareness, and responsibility of true digital literacy .

Task 1: Create a Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

I created the infographic using Canva, an online design tool that allows users to produce professional quality visuals easily. It focuses on key aspects of digital literacy including understanding digital tools, practicing safe internet habits, and understanding email etiquettes. Each section uses concise text, icons, and colour coded sections to help viewers quickly get the main ideas. This layout was chosen to make the infographic suitable for brochures and digital displays. One interesting aspect of the process was experimenting with visuals, deciding how to balance text and images so that the design remained engaging without becoming cluttered. It was also challenging to combine complex topics into short, impactful statements while keeping the overall design visually appealing.

Task 2: Build Your Student Digital Portfolio

I created and set up accounts on three platforms: GitHub, LinkedIn, and Stack Overflow.

GitHub is a version control and code hosting platform used by developers worldwide. I created a profile README repository containing my name, branch, year, and a brief statement about what I hope to learn. I plan to use GitHub over the next four years to store projects, contribute to open source repos, and demonstrate my practical coding skills to future employers.

LinkedIn is a professional networking platform. I filled in my education section with my current degree, institution, and expected graduation year. I plan to add internships and projects, and use it to connect with professionals and explore career opportunities.

Stack Overflow is a community platform for programmers to ask and answer technical questions. I set up my profile and plan to use it as a learning resource throughout my degree.

Task 3: Explore Coding & Collaboration Platforms

HackerRank is an online coding platform that offers challenges across domains such as Python, data structures, and algorithms, making it highly relevant for engineering students to strengthen their programming skills.

I set up my HackerRank profile and the first problem I solved was "Solve Me First" which involved writing a function to compute the sum of two integers. It helped me understand how HackerRank structures its problems with function descriptions, input constraints, and expected outputs.

I plan to continue using HackerRank throughout my degree to tackle harder challenges, earn skill certifications, and prepare for technical placement interviews in my final year.

Task 4: Draft a Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

Checklist:

Do's

- Keep your professional profiles accurate and up to date.
 - Think before you post.
 - Use privacy settings to control who can view your personal posts and information.
 - Engage positively by participating in academic discussions.
 - Credit original creators when sharing someone else's work.
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Don'ts

- Do not share personal information publicly.
 - Do not post offensive, discriminatory, or emotionally charged content.
 - Do not connect with unknown accounts offering jobs, prizes, or opportunities without verifying them first.
 - Do not mix your professional and personal tone.
 - Do not ignore suspicious activity on your accounts.
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Poor Digital Communication Situation:

A situation where poor digital communication caused a real problem involves a college student who applied for a campus hackathon. After being shortlisted, the organiser sent a formal email asking for confirmation of participation. The student replied with "yeah I'm in, will come." The student arrived on the day expecting to participate and found that their seat had been given to someone else.

What could have been done differently is simple, a one line professional reply such as "Dear Sir, I confirm my participation. Thank you for the opportunity" would have avoided the situation entirely.

Task 5: Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guide

I researched about UPI and online payment fraud as my chosen cybercrime type. I wrote a case study on a real published article. I also created a Stay Safe Online prevention checklist with nine tips relevant to college students in India, including two tips focused on UPI and financial safety, along with the National Cyber Crime Helpline number and the reporting portal.

What surprised me most during my research was the scale of the problem. According to Ministry of Finance data presented in the Lok Sabha, UPI fraud cases increased by 85% in just one.

The one habit I will personally change is to always verify the UPI collect request type before entering my PIN. I now understand that entering a PIN confirms a payment going out, not coming in.

Conclusion

This project helped me move beyond surface level digital tool usage and develop a more responsible and aware sense in the digital world. Through five tasks, I created an awareness infographic using Canva, built professional profiles on GitHub, LinkedIn, and Stack Overflow, practised coding on HackerRank, collaborated on a Google Form, wrote formal emails, researched real cybercrime, and made checklists. The most important takeaway from this project is that digital literacy is not a one-time lesson but a continuous habit of verifying and reflecting on every digital action we take.

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